

TONG SUO

University of Michigan, Department of Psychology

1004 East Hall, 530 Church St., Ann Arbor, MI, 48109

Email: tongsuo@umich.edu | [Google Scholar](#) | ORCID: [0000-0003-2648-7737](#)

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Rackham Graduate School, Ann Arbor, MI Fall 2020 - Present

Dissertation committee: Catherine Thomas (chair), David Dunning, Richard Gonzalez, and Shinobu Kitayama.

Master of Science, Social Psychology (August 2022)

Certificate of Graduate Studies in Data Science (December 2024)

Cornell University, College of Arts & Sciences, Ithaca, NY

Fall 2015 - May 2019

Bachelor of Arts with Distinctions in All Subjects, Magna Cum Laude Psychology;

Minors in Information Science, Cognitive Science, and East Asian Studies

GPA: 4.12 / 4.30 (Dean's List: Fall 2015-Spring 2019)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Culture (outside of WEIRD), Self, Psychological Well-Being, Interventional Science, Predictive Modeling

PUBLICATIONS

Manuscript Under Preparation & Preprints

Suo, T., Gonzelz, R., & Thomas, C. C. (*under review*). Beyond Self Worth: Social Worth as a Foundation of Subjective Well-being in Sub-Saharan Africa. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/k8hwg_v2

Note. This paper received 2025 Philip Brickman Memorial Prize Award from Department of Psychology, University of Michigan.

Published Journal Articles

Wang, Q., **Suo, T.**, Mei, L., Guan, L., Hou, Y., & Dai, Y. (2024). Do future actions matter more than past deeds? Temporal moral attribution in U.S. and Chinese school-age children. *Developmental Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001825>

Wang, Q., & **Suo, T.** (2023) Social-distancing memories and well-being in the cultural context. *Applied Cognitive Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/acp.4123>

Song, Q., Lent, M., Murray-Close, D., **Suo, T.**, & Wang, Q. (2023). Narrative processing and the forms and functions of aggressive behavior: Exploring the roles of physiological reactivity and gender. *Narrative Inquiry*. <https://doi.org/10.1075/ni.22018.son>

Suo, T., & Wang, Q. (2021) Culture and visual perspective in mental time travel: the relations to psychological well-being, *Journal of Cognitive Psychology*. <http://doi.org/10.1080/20445911.2021.1982951>

Song, Q., Lent, M. C., **Suo, T.**, Murray-Close, D., & Wang, Q. (2021). Relational victimization and depressive symptoms: The interactive role of physiological reactivity and narrative processing. *International Journal of Psychophysiology*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijpsycho.2021.05.009>

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Chaired Symposia

Suo, T. (2026, February). *The Social Roots of Well-being: Relational and Affective Processes Across Cultural Contexts*. SPSP Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

Recent Conference Presentations

Suo, T., Gonzalez, R. & Thomas C.C. (2026, February). *The Centrality of Social Worth to Life Satisfaction in Sub-Saharan Africa*. Symposium talk presented for SPSP Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

Suo, T. & Dunning, A. D. (2026, February). *Evaluate Your Own Performance, But Be Accountable*. Poster presented for SPSP Judgement and Decision Making Preconference, Denver, CO.

Suo, T. & Dunning, A. D. (2025, February). *Hold Yourself Accountable. Think Twice or Be Humble?* Poster presented for SPSP Judgement and Decision Making Preconference, Denver, CO.

Suo, T., Rossmair, A., Osei-Tutu, A., Ishii, K., Thomas, C. C. & Kitayama, S. (2025, February). *Affect Experience, Values, and Relation to Well-being in the U.S., Japan, Kenya and Ghana*. Poster presented for SPSP Annual Conference, Denver, CO.

Suo, T., & Thomas, C. C. (2024, February). *Inside the mind or out in the world? Identifying Determinants of Psychological Well-being in Sub-Saharan African Cultures with Machine Learning*. Poster presented for SPSP Advances in Cultural Psychology Preconference, San Diego, CA.

Suo, T., Thomas, C. C., & Kitayama, S. (2024, February). *Inductive Identification of Cultural Features in Sub-Saharan Africa using Large-Scale Data: Vertical Collectivism, Social Vigilance, and the Centrality of Socioeconomic Status*. Poster presented for SPSP Annual Convention, San Diego, CA.

Suo, T. & Kitayama, S. (2023, February). *Support Seeking as a Form of Control? A Cross-Cultural Investigation with American and Japanese Adult*. Poster presented at SPSP Annual Convention, Atlanta, GA.

Suo, T., Park, J., & Kitayama, S. (2022, February). *Will Purpose Buffer Stress? Moderation by Culture and Education Attainment*. Poster presented at SPSP Annual Convention, virtual conference.

Suo, T. & Wang, Q. (2021, February). *Do You See Yourself in Time? The Role of Culture in Visual Perspective and Psychological Outcomes*. Poster presented at SPSP Annual Convention, virtual conference.

Invited Talks

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI (2024, February). Guest lecture for PSYCH 487 – Cultural Psychology.

Lecture Title: Inductive Identification of sub-Saharan African Cultural Features

Busara Center of Behavioral Economics, Nairobi, Kenya (2024, August). Talk presented at Behavioral Research and Academic Engagements (BRACE) internal meeting.

Talk Title: Psychological Wellbeing & Interpersonal Relationship in Kenya

FELLOWSHIPS

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program

\$159,000 in total

Funder: National Science Foundation

Funding Period: 36 months of funding between 2022 September and 2027 August

RESEARCH GRANTS

Jonides Graduate Research Award

\$1,000

Title: Target of Accountability and Its Impact on (Over)confidence

Role: Primary Investigator

Funder: University of Michigan, Department of Psychology

Funding Period: December 2025 - Present

Robert B. Zajonc Scholars Fund		\$3,024
Title:	Life Satisfaction Predicted by Self Esteem and Relational Esteem in the U.S. and sub-Saharan Africa	
Role:	Primary Investigator	
Funder:	University of Michigan, Research Center for Group Dynamics	
Funding Period:	December 2024 – Present	
Rackham Post-Candidate Graduate Student Research Grant		\$3,000
Title:	Globalizing Cultural Psychology: Cognitive Debrief and Local Forecasts in Kenya	
Role:	Student Investigator	
Funder:	University of Michigan, Rackham Graduate School	
Funding Period:	June 2024 – Present	
Hough Summer Research Award		\$2,000
Title:	Globalizing Cultural Psychology: Cognitive Debrief and Local Forecasts in Kenya	
Role:	Primary Investigator	
Funder:	University of Michigan, Department of Psychology	
Funding Period:	April 2024 – August 2024	
Pillsbury Graduate Research Award		\$2,500
Title:	Accountability on Self-Evaluation	
Role:	Primary Investigator	
Funder:	University of Michigan, Department of Psychology	
Funding Period:	February 2024 – May 2025	
Rackham Pre-candidate Graduate Student Research Grant		\$1,500
Title:	Globalizing Cultural Psychology: Interdependence in Sub-Saharan Africa	
Role:	Student Investigator	
Funder:	University of Michigan, Rackham Graduate School	
Funding Period:	October 2022 – Present	
Undergraduate Research Program		\$500
Title:	Cultural and Gender Influences on Future Predictions	
Role:	Principal Investigator	
Funder:	Cornell University	
Funding Period:	September 2018 – May 2019	
Einhorn Discovery Grant		\$500
Title:	Cultural and Gender Influences on Future Predictions	
Role:	Principal Investigator	
Funder:	Cornell University	
Funding Period:	September 2017 – May 2018	

TRAINING GRANTS

Institute of Social Research (ISR)-Rackham Summer Training Award		\$10,825 in total
Funder:	Department of Psychology and Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan	
Funding Period:	May 2026, June – August 2023, June – July 2022, and June – August 2021	
Training Program:	Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR) Summer Program - Machine learning for social sciences	

- Computational Language Modeling for the Social Sciences
- Modern Methods for Interaction & Heterogeneous Treatment Effects
- Scaling and dimension reduction
- Network analysis

TRAVEL GRANTS

- 2023 - **Rackham Conference Travel Grant**
 2026 Rackham Graduate School, University of Michigan
- 2021 **Dallas Aging & Cognition Conference Travel Assistance**
 Sallie P. Asche Travel Award Fund
Note. In-person conference cancelled due to COVID pandemic.
- 2021 **SPSP Graduate Student Travel/ Registration Award**
 Society for Personality and Social Psychology

SERVICE AWARDS

- 2025 **Claudia Joan Alexander Trailblazer Award**
 Women in Science and Engineering (WISE), University of Michigan
Note. Claudia Joan Alexander Trailblazer Award recognizes achievement and outstanding advocacy for broadening participation in STEM, and especially honors individuals or teams for the development or implementation of a program, innovation, or intervention that supports success for all students in STEM at the university. This is a group award granted to Psychology Scholarship, Transferable skills, Academia & Research (STAR) Scholars Program where I serve as a mentor. STAR is an educational outreach initiative designed to facilitate underrepresented students' involvement in research, ensure equal opportunities for students, and continue to break down barriers and ensure success for all students.
- 2022 **Carol Hollenshead Inspire Award**
 Center for the Education of Women+, University of Michigan
Note. Carol Hollenshead Inspire Award recognizes excellence in promoting equity and social change. This is a group award granted to Psychology Scholarship, Transferable skills, Academia & Research (STAR) Scholars Program where I served as a mentor.

MENTORING & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Honors Theses

- 2025 - 2026 Sydney Lesnick
 Thesis title: *Induced Humility as a Deterrent for Planning Fallacy: Exploring the Moderating Role of Normal Narcissism.*
- 2024 - 2025 Megan Pham
 Thesis title: *Is Loneliness Always Bad? The Moderating Effect of Culture.*
Note. Nominated for Psychology Excellence in Mentoring Award in the same academic year. The thesis student presented this work as an undergraduate poster at 2025 SPSP Annual Convention in Denver, CO.

Courses

University of Michigan, Department of Psychology | Ann Arbor, MI
 Graduate Student Instructor

- Introduction to Psychology

January 2026 – Present

Served as the course instructor for 75 students across 3 sections; collaborated with the main instructor and other graduate student instructors to design weekly discussion lectures and quizzes materials; supervise course administrative; led weekly discussion sections and office hours; built and maintained section website on Canvas.

- Introduction to Social Psychology January 2021 – April 2022

Served as the course instructor for 3 semesters (2021 Winter, 2021 Fall, 2022 Winter); collaborated with the main instructor and other graduate student instructors to design course materials and make logistic arrangements on a weekly basis; led weekly discussion sections; held office hours to answer questions from students; built and maintained section website on Canvas; graded assignments and maintained gradebook; collaborated with the instructional team to design test question; communicated with students and the instructional team.

Cornell University, Department of Human Development | Ithaca, NY

Teaching Assistant

- Quantitative Method I & II August 2018 – May 2019

Developed grading rubric and graded homework with another teaching assistant, collaborated with course instructor during office hours for a class of 47 students to answer questions about descriptive statistics, exploratory data analysis, basic inferential statistics with a focus on analyzing experimental designs, and the use of statistics package R. Communicated with instructor on students' performances and questions in homework. Selected as the first undergraduate teaching assistant for this graduate level course.

SERVICES

University of Michigan | Ann Arbor, MI

STAR Scholars Program

September 2020 – January 2025

Mentor

Attend weekly mentor meetings to discuss program design and logistics; collaborate in a team of 2 or 3 to design workshop materials and coordinate with guest speakers; hold small-group meetings with 5 undergraduate mentees to discuss cv/ resume build-up, mock interview and identifying research interests; lead big-group meetings with 30 - 50 attendees to discuss how to identify and secure research opportunities, professional development, and data collection and analyses.

Departmental Associate Council

August 2023 – May 2024

Graduate Student Representative for Social Psychology

Participate in monthly departmental faculty meetings to vote on departmental administrative matters; communicate with departmental leadership regarding graduate students' needs and concerns.

Social Psychology Doctoral Program Admissions Committee

December 2021 – January 2022

Graduate Student Member

Reviewed and rated 45 applicants; attended meetings with 4 faculty members and 3 other graduate students to develop admission and wait list.

Cornell University | Ithaca, NY

Psychological Society Yielding Cornell Health Practitioners (P.S.Y.C.H)

August 2016 – December 2018

Executive Member

Budgeted expenses of \$100 - \$200 every semester; managed reimbursement applications; coordinated and promoted club events through listserv and flyer distribution; contacted speakers for speech panels; assisted with club member recruitment via targeted mailing lists and outreach.

Undergraduate Research Board Peer Mentorship Program

August 2016 – May 2018

Peer Mentor

Counselled undergraduate mentees on gaining research experience; answered mentees' questions

related to lab applications and experience; led lab tour and introduced ongoing projects to mentees.

SKILLS & TRAINING

Statistics Software: Proficient in R and RStudio. Experience with SPSS, MPlus, STATA, and Tableau.

Study Design Software: Proficient in Qualtrics. Experience with E-Prime 2 and PsychoPy.

Programming Language Skills: Experience with Python and SQL.

Language Skills: Mandarin-Chinese (Native). English (Proficient). Japanese (Intermediate).

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Society for Personality and Social Psychology	February 2020 – Present
Psi Chi, International Honor Society in Psychology	March 2016 – Present
Phi Beta Kappa, Academic Honor Society	March 2018 – Present

REFERENCES

Dr. Catherine Thomas
Assistant Professor of Psychology and
Organizational Studies
University of Michigan
thomascc@umich.edu

Dr. David Dunning
Mary Ann and Charles R. Walgreen, Jr., Professor
of the Study of Human Understanding
Professor of Psychology
University of Michigan
ddunning@umich.edu

Dr. Shinobu Kitayama
Robert B. Zajonc Collegiate Professor of
Psychology
University of Michigan
kitayama@umich.edu

Dr. Qi Wang
Joan K. and Irwin M. Jacobs Professor of Human
Development and Psychology
Cornell University
giwang@cornell.edu